



MARCUS YAM Los Angeles Times



PAUL KURODA For The Times

THE COFFEY PARK neighborhood of Santa Rosa is shown after the 2017 Tubbs fire, top, and as it is today. Five neighborhood residents died in the fire. The residents of Coffey Park were roused from their beds in a panic and fled through flames.

L.A. may learn from Santa Rosa

The sky above their newly built homes was clear, and the ground beneath their feet reassuringly soggy from recent winter rains. But as residents in the Coffey Park neighborhood made their way to a community gathering on a recent evening — passing one yard after another devoid of trees or brush or anything readily flammable — many said they still have flashbacks to a night of smoke and flames and fear.

It's been more than seven years since homes in this Santa Rosa neighborhood were incinerated by the Tubbs fire, which swept across Napa and Sonoma counties in a matter of hours before jumping six lanes of the 101 Freeway. The residents of Coffey Park —

Survivors of the 2017 Tubbs fire have a message for those now victimized: It is possible to recover

BY JESSICA GARRISON
REPORTING FROM SANTA ROSA, CALIF.

about 9,000 people — were roused from their beds in a panic and fled through flames and whipping embers. In some cases, people walked miles to safety, with singed pets struggling in their arms and only the clothes on their backs.

Five neighborhood residents died in the fire, among 22 total in Sonoma County. At the time, it was the most destructive fire in California history — although that record would quickly be broken, and then broken again in the coming years.

Fire wasn't supposed to do what it did that night. No one had predicted the flames would move so fast, or consume so much of this city

[See Tubbs, A9]

State immigrants gripped by fear

Leticia Jimenez expects to graduate from Cal State San Bernardino this spring with a degree in business administration.

She came to the country without authorization when she was 2 years old and grew up working the fields of the Coachella Valley with her parents when school was out.

She would be excited about the new opportunities her degree might present but instead feels anxious every time she leaves the house. “I make sure that I say a good ‘goodbye’ to my parents,” she said. “I go out with more fear — anything can happen.”

Jimenez, 21, is like millions of undocumented immigrants living in California whose lives have become deeply woven into the state's economy and social fabric — and who are rattled by the flurry of executive orders

[See Uncertainty, A6]

Worry spreads as Trump rolls out his plans to crack down on people who are in the country illegally

BY RUBEN VIVES, JESSICA GARRISON,
RACHEL URANGA, REBECCA PLEVIN



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

COMMUNITY MEMBERS show their opposition to deportations this week at a Koreatown church vigil.

Bonta assails Trump’s ‘scare tactics’ aimed at state and local officials

BY FAITH E. PINHO,
KERI BLAKINGER
AND RUBEN VIVES

WASHINGTON — As part of President Trump's crackdown on illegal immigration, the Department of Justice will be empowered to investigate and even criminally prosecute government officials who do not comply with restrictive orders on immigration.

The move, outlined in an internal memo reported by multiple news outlets Wednesday, effectively puts a target on the backs of many state and local California officials, who have vociferously defended measures designed to make it possible for undocumented immigrants to work and get an ed-

ucation in the state.

The memo from acting U.S. Deputy Atty. Gen. Emil Bove instructs state and local officials to comply with federal immigration directives and echoes lines Trump hammered on the campaign trail about the threat of undocumented immigrants in the country — such as gangs, drugs and crime. Studies have found that immigrants commit crimes at lower rates than American citizens.

“Federal law prohibits state and local actors from resisting, obstructing, and otherwise failing to comply with lawful immigration-related commands,” the memo reads, adding that the U.S. Attorney's office and Department of Justice

[See Bonta, A6]

Late alerts during fire stir anger

Some question whether racially diverse western Altadena, where 17 died, was neglected.

BY TERRY CASTLEMAN,
GRACE TOOHEY,
SALVADOR HERNANDEZ
AND REBECCA ELLIS

Even as their son fled from his eastern Altadena condo in the early evening of Jan. 7 — not long after the Eaton fire ignited — Justin Chapman's parents remained in their family home about a half-mile away.

Their neighborhood just west of North Lake Avenue had yet to receive any evacuation alerts, Chapman said, so his parents felt safe at home and waited for officials to determine whether they might be in harm's way.

“They decided to stick it out and went to sleep that night, and then woke up at 3 in the morning with a firestorm blowing around their house and embers flying over their house,” Chapman said. “At that point, it still wasn't an evacuation [order].”

But with the blaze barreling down on their family home, Chapman's parents fled. They didn't hear any officials knock on their door or alert residents with a loud-speaker, he said.

“They were very lucky that they woke up when they did,” Chapman said. “It's really concerning that it was so many hours later, essentially when it was too late — homes were on fire.”

The evacuation order for much of the area was finally issued around 3:30 a.m., nearly nine hours after the fire broke out. The area also never received electronic evacuation warnings before then, even as multiple spot fires were reported to have broken out west of the North Lake Avenue boundary, according to a review by The Times.

Revelations about the timing of the evacuations have added more unease and anger in Altadena, where at least 17 lives and more than 9,000 structures — many of them homes — were lost in the fire.

All known deaths from the fire occurred in neighborhoods west of North Lake Avenue, where electronic evacuation orders were issued around 3:30 a.m. — or later, in some cases. Witnesses said L.A. County

[See Alerts, A7]

Hughes fire shuts down I-5

The blaze north of Castaic quickly explodes, forcing more than 19,000 to evacuate. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Sasaki receives hero's welcome

Dodgers' leadership says it plans to “hit the ground running” with latest talented pitcher from Japan. **SPORTS, B12**

Tech giants plan big AI venture

A trio of companies intends to spend \$500 billion over the next four years on the initiative. **BUSINESS, A8**

Weather

Sunny and very warm. L.A. Basin: 80/50. **B8**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.

Printed with soy inks on partially recycled paper.

